COMPANY TEARDOWN · A READER'S GUIDE

What a teardown is

An outside-in review of how a business earns customers, and a guide to reading the report that comes with this document.

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COMPANION TO
The teardown report

SOURCES
Public only

Everything in a teardown comes from public sources: the website, reviews, listings, events, and content a prospect can find on their own. No form submissions, no mystery shopping, no contacting staff.

01 / WHAT A TEARDOWN IS

Everything a prospect can see, read the way a prospect reads it.

A teardown is an outside-in review of how a business earns customers. I look at everything a prospect can see before they ever talk to you: your website, your reviews, your listings, your events, your content, and your competitors. Then I show you what is working, where you are exposed, and the moves that matter most.

Everything comes from public sources. No form submissions, no mystery shopping, no contacting your staff. What I find is what your prospect finds, and that is the point.

02 / WHY IT IS VALUABLE

Owners see the homepage they built. Prospects see the search result they click.

Most owners never see their business the way a first-time prospect sees it. They see the homepage they built, not the search result a nervous buyer actually clicks. A teardown closes that gap in one document.

It answers three questions. First, what is already working, so you protect it. Second, where you are exposed, stated plainly and in order of importance. Third, what to do next, narrowed to a short list of moves with the single biggest opening named first. It also says what I could not see, because an honest boundary is more useful than a confident guess.

The result is a document you can act on Monday morning. No 40-page deck, no vague recommendations, no jargon.

03 / TWO WAYS TO USE IT

Same method, two targets: the mirror and the map.

A teardown comes in two flavors, and they do different jobs.

	THE SELF-AUDIT (INTERNAL)	THE COMPETITOR TEARDOWN (EXTERNAL)
Pointed at	Your own firm.	A rival firm.
The job	The mirror: what a prospect finds when they research you, and the easy wins hiding in plain sight.	The map: how they win customers, where their armor is thin, and the exact opening you can take.
What you get	The truth about your first impression, before a competitor or a reviewer hands it to you.	Their playbook, and the gap in it.

Same method, same evidence rules. Different target, different job.

04 / HOW TO READ THE REPORT

Every teardown follows the same structure.

1. **What is working.** The strengths worth protecting, backed by what I observed.
2. **Where you are exposed.** The gaps and weak spots, in plain language, most important first.
3. **The single biggest opening.** One paragraph. The highest-leverage thing I found.
4. **Three moves, in order.** A short action list, sequenced so you know what to do first.
5. **What I could not see.** The open questions, labeled honestly instead of filled in with guesses.

Every important claim carries its source and the date I observed it. Where I am interpreting rather than observing, I say so.

05 / EXAMPLES OF THE WORK

Three teardowns, three different kinds of business.

TEARDOWN	WHAT IT LOOKED AT
Empire Today funnel teardown	A full walkthrough of a national home-services funnel: how it captures demand, where it leaks, and what a local competitor could borrow.
Supportersgolf funnel teardown	A conversion review of a solo-run golf business, built to find why the conversion rate was too low and what would move it.
Vitou Financial Services self-audit	An internal teardown for a family-run retirement planning firm in Rocky River, Ohio. It found a strong seminar engine, thin online proof, and three moves in order, starting with building a review and story library.

06 / WHY THIS EXISTS

The outside-in view is the one owners almost never get.

I build these because the outside-in view is the one owners almost never get. Everything in a teardown comes from public sources, checked and dated, with interpretations and unknowns labeled as what they are. It is the same discipline whether the target is a firm I am studying or one I am helping.

The examples above are real work: a national home-services funnel, a solo-run golf business, and a family financial firm in Ohio. If you are reading a teardown of mine, the document in your hands is the method, applied.

THE METHOD, IN ONE LINE

Public sources only. Every claim sourced and dated. Interpretations and unknowns labeled as what they are.

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